

Trademarks

A trade name is the name under which a concern does business (IBM, Sigma, Xerox). A trademark or brand name is a proprietary name protected by law.

Popular use of trademarks can lead to their unrestricted use as unprotected common nouns: aspirin, cellophane, kerosene, milk of magnesia, nylon.

General Guidelines:

If possible, use a generic term.

If a trademark is used, include the generic term (Kleenex tissues or Vaseline petroleum jelly). The supplier and their location may be put in parentheses. After the first occurrence, use only the generic term. Sometimes this is not possible or is awkward (Dacron and Pyrex), so in these cases, just use the trademark.

The first letter of a trademark should be capitalized.

Do not use other marks (TM, [®]) to indicate a trademark.

If a term cannot be found in the attached list or in one of the sources, query the authors, follow their use of capitalization, and be consistent throughout the manuscript.

For equipment and reagents, trademarks and brand names can be put in parentheses after the generic term. These are needed only when the product used is different from others or its source is important for some reason. Copy editors should assume that the given information is necessary if it remains in the revised manuscript. The author should be queried for the city and state of the manufacturer if the company is not is not well-known (as are Amersham, Boehringer, Sigma, and Stratagene, for example).

For drugs, the trade name and commercial source (the source is optional; if unnecessary, it should be deleted in the pre-edit) may be given in parentheses after the first use of the generic name: gentamicin (Bristagen; Bristol Laboratories).

Do not substitute experimental names or code designations of a drug for the approved name, if one exists; however, they may be given parenthetically after the first mention.

Trademarks should not be used as verbs: One photocopies a page on a Xerox copier; one does not Xerox a page.

Trademarks should not be pluralized. Use the generic term: two Kodak cameras, not two Kodaks.

Trademarks should not be used in the possessive form, unless the apostrophe is part of the name: Levi's, McDonald's.

Only a few buffers and stains are included in this list. Check that section of the style manual or a source.

Sources Used

Bio-Rad	Bio-Rad products list (1994)
Ed	<i>Science</i> editor (or initials where known)
G&H	<i>Grant and Hackh's Chemical Dictionary</i> , ed. 5 (1987)
GPO	<i>Government Printing Office Style Manual</i> (March 1984)
H	<i>Hawley's Condensed Chemical Dictionary</i> (1993)
ITA	"A Guide to Proper Trademark Use," International Trademark Association
Merck	<i>Merck Index</i> , 11th ed. (1989)
PDR	<i>Physician's Desk Reference</i> (1994) (pink pages)
USAN	<i>USP Dictionary of USAN and International Drug Names</i> (1993)
Web III	<i>Webster's Third International Dictionary</i> (1981)
Web IX	<i>Webster's Ninth New Collegiate Dictionary</i> (1990)

There is an online service called TRADEMARKSCAN that claims to have a database of information on trademarks from 1884 to the present that is updated twice a week. They also claim to have cross-references to eliminate incorrect entries. The reliability of this source is not clear.

Trademark	Generic term (or notes)	Source
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A

Acrilan		H
Adrenalin	adrenaline, epinephrine (adrenalin is a generic term in UK)	Merck
Affi-Gel	affinity chromatography support	Bio-Rad
Alemite		GPO
Alumel		GPO
Alundum		Merck
Amytal	sodium amytal	H
Areskap		GPO
Aresket		GPO
Aresklene		GPO

B

Bactratycin		GPO
Benzedrine	amphetamine sulfate	H
Bio-Gel	chromatography support	Bio-Rad
Bio-Rex	ion-exchange chromatography support	Bio-Rad

C

Cab-O-Sil	colloidal silica particles sintered together	H
Calgon		H
Calrod		GPO
Carbitol		H
Carbofrax		GPO
Carborundum		H
Catalin	pirenoxine	Merck
Celanese CL or Solvent		H
Celastix		GPO
Cellocotton	surgical dressing	GPO
Cellosolve	(used as solvent)	H
Celluloid		H
Celotex		H
Chelex	ion-exchange chromatography support	Ed
Chlorex	bleach (not Clorox)	H
Chromel	(alloy)	GPO
Chromosorb		H
Conelrad		GPO
Corex	type of glass	GPO

D

Dacron		H
Dalamar	azo yellow pigment	H
Decalin		H
Deepfreeze		Web III
De-Ion		Web III
Demerol	meperidine	H
Dexedrine	dextroamphetamine	H
Duralumin	(alloy)	Web III
Duraplex		H

E

Emulphor		Merck
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F

FACScan	fluorescence-activated cell sorter	Ed
Fathometer		Web III
Fiberglas	glass fibers	H
Ficoll-Hypaque	(for density gradients)	Ed
Filtrol		H
Foamite		Web III
Formalin	<i>para</i> -formaldehyde-methanol solution	G&H
Formvar	polyvinyl formaldehyde plastic	G&H
Freon		H

G

Geon		H
Glyptal		Web III
Gramoxone		Merck

H

Halon	polytetrafluoroethylene (PTFE)	H
Halon 1211	compressed gas (fire extinguishers)	H
Halon 1301	CBrF	H
Hercoflex		H
Hercoloid		H
Hercolyn		H
Hi-Sil	group of silicas	H

I

Immobilon	artificial membrane	Ed
Incoloy		H
Inconel		H
Invar		H

J

K

Kevlar		H
Kleenex	tissues	ITA
Kodak	camera or film	ITA
Kodak		H
Kodol		H
Koroseal		Merck
Kraton		H

L

Lastex		Web IX
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M

Merthiolate	thimerosal solution, preservative	H
Methocel	methylcellulose	H
Micarta		H
Monel	(Ni-Cu alloy)	H
Mylar	(polyester) film	H

N

Nembutal	pentobarbitol	Merck
Nichrome	(alloy)	H
Novocaine	(procaine hydrochloride)	H
Nujol	mineral oil (used in IR spectroscopy)	H

O

Orlon		H
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P

Paraplex		H
Parco		H
Parcolene		H
Parlodion		Merck
Pentothal	sodium thiopental	H
Photostat	(not capped if used as a verb)	Web IX
Plastacele		H
Plexiglas	acrylic plastic (be sure to define, not used in UK)	H
Pliofilm		Web IX
Polaroid	film, camera, and other equipment	Web IX
Pyralin	celluloid	Merck
Pyrex	heat-resistant borosilicate glass	H

Q

R

RNAzol	single-step method of RNA isolation	Ed
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S

Sanforized		Web IX
Santomerse 1	sodium dodecylbenzenesulfonate	Merck
Seconal	secobarbital	Merck
Sephadex		H
Sepharose	protein A, etc.	VJ
Silastic		H
Skellysolve	A through H, L (i.e., Skellysolve B, etc.)	Merck
Spectrafluor		Ed
Starburst	(branched or star) dendrimer	EGM
Streptozyme	diagnostic kit	Ed
Strobane	insecticide	Merck
Styrofoam	plastic foam (try to reword, not used in UK)	H
Syton		H

T

Talon	rodenticide	Merck
Technicolor		Web IX
Teflon	polytetrafluoroethylene (PTFE)	H
Terramycin		H
Thermit	thermite	Web IX
Thermos	(can be used generically)	Web IX
Thiokol		Merck
Tris	tromethamine	Merck
	the solution tris(hydroxymethylamino)methane is not a trademark	
Triton X-(number)	a series of octoxynols	Merck
Tween-(number)	polyoxyethylene sorbitan (polysorbate)	USAN

U

Uformite		H
Urotropin (New)		Merck

V

Varsol		Merck
Vaseline	petroleum jelly	Merck
Veronal	use barbitol	Merck
Vinylite		Merck
Vistac A		H
Vistanex MM		H
Vultex	vulcanized or synthetic rubber latex	H

W

X

Xerox	copier, photocopier	ITA
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Y

Z